AUDIENCE GROWTH & CONTENT STRATEGY

# BEYOND THE SCREEN

## The Masked Singer + The Floor

Public evidence. Distinct participation formats. A measurable pilot.

Independent project. Not affiliated with or endorsed by FOX. No internal FOX data.

# A participation pilot for two different viewing habits

## The proposed decision

Allocate a 30-day discovery pilot to clue-led participation for The Masked Singer and category play for The Floor.

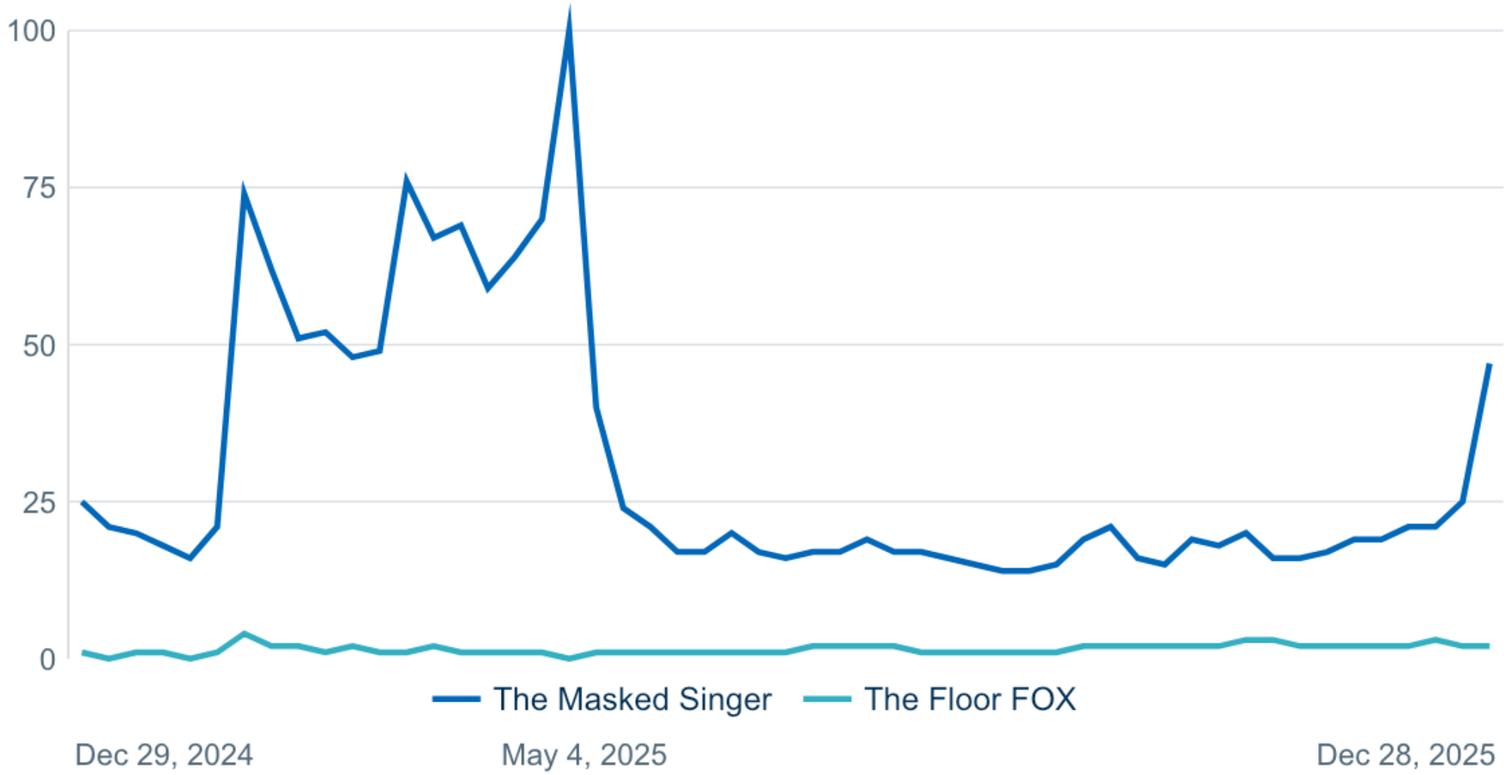
## The evidence boundary

53 weekly Trends observations and 5 public YouTube videos inform timing and creative questions. They do not establish audience overlap or causal lift.

## Success = more qualified episode-page visits per 1,000 impressions

Hypothesis: inviting viewers to make a choice before the payoff can increase intent to watch.

# The Masked Singer search peaks in spring



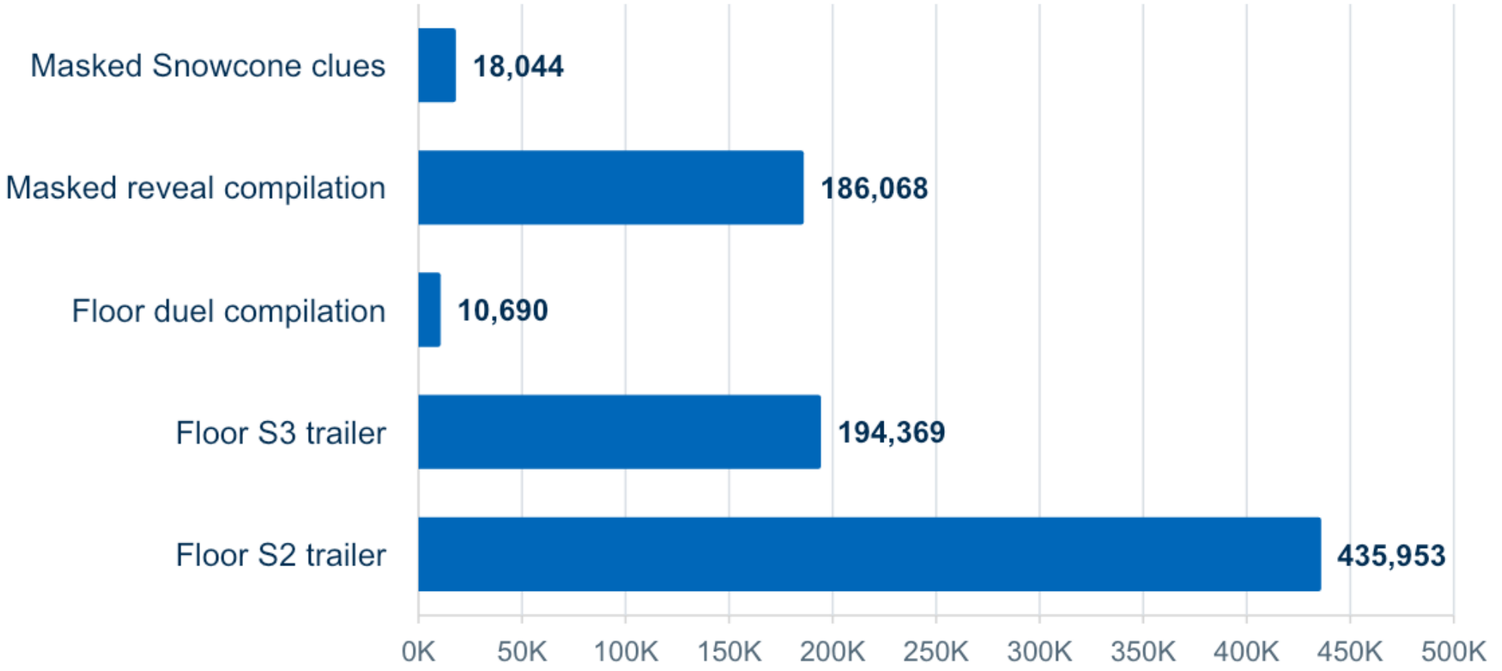

**100**

**Peak week starts May 4, 2025**

Timing signal only
Query wording biases the comparison. The Floor FOX returns unrelated FOX News queries.

US Web Search, all categories, Jan 1–Dec 31, 2025. 53 displayed weekly bins include boundary weeks. Index 0–100, jointly normalized. Source: Google Trends, accessed Oct 19, 2026.

# Public view totals vary widely across a small sample




## 5 public videos

Published Sep 2024–Jul 2026
Different channels and exposure periods

## No format winner

Age and distribution confound views. One unlisted upload is excluded.

Direct watch-page observations, Oct 19, 2026. Official show/FOX-linked channels. Source URLs and counts in youtube_observations.csv. Convenience sample, n=5.

# A clue-first invitation protects the reveal

## Creative concept

“One clue. One guess.”
A 20–30 second clip with an unresolved clue invites a prediction before the reveal.

## Publishing treatment

Lead with the clue in the first 2 seconds. Add captions and a prediction prompt. Delay spoiler imagery until after a clear warning.

## Example copy: “The clue is on screen. Who is behind the mask?”

Test clue-first vs. performance-first edits from the same episode. Same length, CTA and distribution.
Primary outcome: qualified episode-page visits / 1,000 impressions. Spoiler complaints are a guardrail.

# A playable category makes the premise immediate

## Creative concept

“Can you name it before the clock?”
A 20–30 second category challenge gives viewers time to answer before the contestant does.

## Publishing treatment

Open with the category and one visual prompt. Keep answers accessible in captions. End with the episode destination and one clear CTA.

## Example copy: “Your category: movie titles. How many can you name?”

Test challenge-first vs. host-introduction edits from the same episode. Clear clip and image rights.
Primary outcome: qualified episode-page visits / 1,000 impressions. Completion rate is a diagnostic.

# An experiment can connect creative choice to intent

## Design and assignment

Run each show separately. Use a platform experiment with randomized equal allocation. Match episode, audience, duration and budget. Avoid organic-post causal claims.

## Primary metric and decision

Qualified visits per 1,000 served impressions. Count a visit after 10 seconds on an owned episode page. Instrument consented sessions with UTMs and event IDs.

## Illustrative planning assumption: 1.0% to 1.2% qualified-visit rate

About 52,000 independent impressions per arm, per show: 80% power, two-sided α=0.025 for two show tests. This is a planning calculation, not a forecast. Repeated exposure needs adjustment.

# A small pilot with a clear evidence trail

DAYS 01–07

## Baseline + rights

Audit 30 recent uploads per show. Separate Shorts, trailers and clips. Confirm topic identifiers, rights and destination tracking.

DAYS 08–14

## Creative + instrumentation

Produce matched variants from two episodes per show. QA captions, spoiler treatment, UTMs and consented event collection.

DAYS 15–30

## Test + decision

Run the prespecified test. Report effect and confidence interval. Scale only if visits improve without material guardrail harm.

Delivery: executive deck, open data, calculation notes and a public-source portfolio site